

# **Practical Lab: Creating a Podcast Using Audacity**

## **Module**

Digital Media Production

## **Practical Title**

**Creating a Professional Podcast Using Audacity**

## **Duration**

2–3 Hours

## **Learning Outcomes**

By the end of this practical, students will be able to:

- Install and configure Audacity.
- Record audio using a microphone.
- Import external audio files.
- Edit recordings.
- Remove unwanted sections.
- Reduce background noise.
- Adjust audio levels.
- Add background music.
- Apply fade effects.
- Export a podcast as MP3.
- Save an editable Audacity project.

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## **Equipment Required**

- Computer (Windows, macOS or Linux)
- Microphone or headset
- Headphones
- Internet connection (for downloading Audacity)
- Audacity installed
- Optional royalty-free background music

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# Scenario

You have been asked to produce a **2–3 minute podcast** introducing yourself and discussing a topic of your choice (technology, sport, education, travel, etc.).

The podcast should include:

- Introduction
- Main discussion
- Background music
- Fade in/out effects
- Clean audio
- Exported MP3

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## Part 1 – Install Audacity

### Step 1

Open your web browser.

Go to the official Audacity website.

Download the latest version suitable for your operating system.

Install the software using the default settings.

Launch Audacity.

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### Expected Screen

You should see:

- Menu bar
- Toolbar
- Recording controls
- Timeline
- Empty audio track area

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## Part 2 – Configure Audio

### Step 2

Connect your microphone.

Open Audacity.

Locate the **Audio Setup** button.

Select:

- Recording Device → Your microphone
- Playback Device → Your headphones or speakers

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### Step 3

Test the microphone.

Click **Record**.

Speak for approximately 10 seconds.

Click **Stop**.

Click **Play**.

Verify that your voice is audible.

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## Part 3 – Record Your Podcast

### Step 4

Prepare the following script.

Example:

Hello everyone. Welcome to my first podcast.

Today I will briefly discuss the importance of cybersecurity in everyday life.

Cybersecurity protects our personal information, financial data and online identity.

Thank you for listening.

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## Step 5

Click **Record**.

Read the script slowly and clearly.

Click **Stop**.

A waveform should appear.

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# Part 4 – Save the Project

## Step 6

Select:

**File → Save Project → Save Project As**

Save as:

`MyFirstPodcast.aup3`

This preserves all editing information.

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# Part 5 – Navigate the Timeline

## Step 7

Use the Zoom tools.

Try:

- Zoom In
- Zoom Out
- Fit Project

Observe how the waveform changes.

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## Part 6 – Select Audio

### Step 8

Choose the **Selection Tool**.

Click and drag across part of the recording.

Notice the highlighted area.

Practice selecting:

- One word
  - One sentence
  - Entire recording
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## Part 7 – Remove Mistakes

Suppose you accidentally said:

"Today I want want to discuss..."

### Step 9

Highlight the repeated word.

Press **Delete**.

Play the recording again.

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## Part 8 – Trim Audio

### Step 10

Select silence at the beginning.

Press Delete.

Repeat for silence at the end.

Your recording should begin immediately.

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## Part 9 – Undo Changes

### Step 11

Select

**Edit → Undo**

Observe that the deleted section returns.

Redo the action using

**Edit → Redo**

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## Part 10 – Noise Reduction

### Step 12

Locate a section containing only background noise.

Highlight approximately 3 seconds.

Choose

**Effect → Noise Removal and Repair → Noise Reduction**

Click

**Get Noise Profile**

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### **Step 13**

Select the entire recording.

Return to

**Noise Reduction**

Click

**OK**

Listen to the improvement.

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## **Part 11 – Amplify Volume**

### **Step 14**

Select the whole recording.

Choose

**Effect → Volume and Compression → Amplify**

Increase volume by approximately

+3 dB

Click OK.

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## **Part 12 – Normalize Audio**

### **Step 15**

Select all.

Choose

**Effect → Volume and Compression → Normalize**

Accept the default settings.

Click OK.

The audio should now have a consistent volume.

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## Part 13 – Add Background Music

### Step 16

Choose

**File → Import → Audio**

Import a royalty-free music file.

A second track appears.

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### Step 17

Reduce music volume.

Select the music track.

Choose

**Effect → Volume and Compression → Amplify**

Reduce by

-20 dB

The music should not overpower the narration.

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## Part 14 – Move Tracks

### Step 18

Use the **Time Shift** feature (or drag clips in newer versions of Audacity) to align the music so it begins with the narration.

Play the project.

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## Part 15 – Fade In

### Step 19

Highlight the first five seconds of the music.

Choose

**Effect → Fading → Fade In**

Play the result.

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## Part 16 – Fade Out

### Step 20

Highlight the last five seconds.

Choose

**Effect → Fading → Fade Out**

Play the ending.

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## Part 17 – Split Audio

### Step 21

Place the cursor in the middle of the narration.

Choose

**Edit → Audio Clips → Split**

Notice that the recording becomes two separate clips.

Move them independently if required.

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## Part 18 – Cut, Copy and Paste

### Step 22

Select a sentence.

Practice:

- Cut
- Copy
- Paste

Undo when finished.

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## Part 19 – Silence Audio

### Step 23

Select a word.

Choose

**Edit → Remove Special → Silence Audio**

Notice that the timing remains unchanged.

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## Part 20 – Add Labels

## Step 24

Choose

**Tracks → Add Label at Selection**

Label sections such as:

- Introduction
  - Main Topic
  - Conclusion
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## Part 21 – Generate Silence

### Step 25

Choose

**Generate → Silence**

Insert a one-second pause between two sections.

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## Part 22 – Listen to the Entire Podcast

### Step 26

Play the complete recording.

Check for:

- Background noise
  - Equal volume
  - Clear speech
  - Appropriate music level
  - Smooth transitions
- 

## Part 23 – Export as MP3

## Step 27

Choose

**File → Export Audio**

Select:

MP3

Filename:

MyPodcast.mp3

Fill in metadata:

| Field       | Example            |
|-------------|--------------------|
| Artist      | Your Name          |
| Album       | Podcast Assignment |
| Track Title | Episode 1          |
| Genre       | Podcast            |

Click Export.

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## Part 24 – Review the Output

Locate the exported MP3.

Open it using a media player.

Confirm that:

- Audio plays correctly
- Music is present
- Volume is acceptable
- No editing mistakes remain

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## Practical Exercise

Create a **2–3 minute podcast** titled:

### **"Technology in Everyday Life"**

The podcast must include:

- Personal introduction
- Discussion of the topic
- Background music
- Noise reduction
- Fade in
- Fade out
- Edited mistakes removed
- MP3 export

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## **Extension Activities**

1. Record two speakers on separate tracks.
2. Add an interview segment.
3. Apply compression to improve voice consistency.
4. Insert sound effects between sections.
5. Add opening and closing jingles.
6. Experiment with equalization to enhance vocal clarity.
7. Create a stereo podcast with panning.
8. Use labels to organize long recordings.
9. Produce a five-minute podcast with three different segments.
10. Compare WAV and MP3 export quality and file sizes.

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## **Assessment Checklist**

| <b>Task</b>           | <b>Completed</b>         |
|-----------------------|--------------------------|
| Installed Audacity    | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Configured microphone | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Recorded narration    | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Saved project         | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Removed mistakes      | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Trimmed silence       | <input type="checkbox"/> |

| Task                    | Completed                |
|-------------------------|--------------------------|
| Applied noise reduction | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Amplified voice         | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Normalized audio        | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Imported music          | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Adjusted music volume   | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Applied fade in         | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Applied fade out        | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Added labels            | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Generated silence       | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Split clips             | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Exported MP3            | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Tested final podcast    | <input type="checkbox"/> |

## References

- Audacity Team. *Audacity Manual*. <https://manual.audacityteam.org/>.
- The Audacity Team. *Audacity Documentation and Tutorials*. <https://www.audacityteam.org/>.
- Hubbard, R. (2020). *The Podcast Handbook*. Routledge.
- Morris, T., & Terra, B. (2020). *Podcasting For Dummies* (4th ed.). Wiley.
- International Telecommunication Union (ITU). (2023). *Digital Media Production Best Practices*.